

Makeup Across a Lifetime

Teen skin, mature skin, pregnancy, and the grace of adjusting technique as skin changes

Learning Objectives

- Recommend age-appropriate makeup guidance for teenage clients
- Adjust texture, finish, and technique for mature skin without changing the client's identity
- Identify ingredients to avoid when a client discloses pregnancy
- Explain why "ageless technique" means adapting, not applying the same approach to every age

The same face, at different points in its story

Technique that flatters one client beautifully can genuinely fail another, not because of any error in skill, but because the skin itself has changed. Age is one of the most common and most overlooked reasons a "correct" technique produces a disappointing result.

Teenage skin

Younger, often oilier and acne-prone skin, per Course I's understanding of adolescent sebum production, benefits from lightweight, non-comedogenic formulas and restraint above all — heavy, occlusive product on skin already prone to congestion tends to worsen breakouts rather than conceal them. This is also frequently a client's first real relationship with makeup; teaching skin-first habits now, per Module Six, shapes years of behaviour ahead.

Mature skin

As skin loses collagen and elastin density with age (Course I, Module Eight), fine lines and looser texture change how product settles. Powder and fully matte formulas tend to sit inside fine lines and emphasise them — cream and liquid formulas, applied with a light, patting

motion rather than dragged or rubbed, generally blend more seamlessly into mature texture. Illuminating, light-reflecting products placed strategically (rather than avoided altogether out of a mistaken belief that shimmer "ages" skin) can restore a healthy-looking glow that flat matte finishes often remove. The goal is never to erase the visible signs of a life lived — it is to make the client feel, and look, like the most polished version of exactly who she already is.

Pregnancy: ingredients to know

A client who discloses pregnancy deserves a quiet, competent adjustment, not a conversation that makes her feel like a liability. Certain ingredients found in some skincare-forward makeup hybrids are generally advised against during pregnancy on a doctor's guidance — retinoids and high-dose salicylic acid among them — and some strong essential oils are best avoided as well. This is not a practitioner's area to diagnose or medically advise; it is an area to ask plainly ("is there anything your doctor has asked you to avoid?") and to have simple, gentler alternatives ready in your kit.

Menopause and shifting skin needs

Declining oestrogen during and after menopause often brings drier, thinner-feeling skin (Course I, Module Eight), which can make some long-wear or heavily mattifying formulas feel uncomfortable or look patchy where they did not before. Hydrating primers and cream-based formulas typically serve this skin far better than the drier long-wear textures that may have suited the same client a decade earlier.

Key Terms

0

[object Object]

1

[object Object]

2

[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Adaptation Exercise

Using the same intended look (for example, a soft daytime glow), describe in writing how your product and technique choices would differ for a sixteen-year-old client, a client in her twenties, and a client in her sixties. Be specific about texture and finish, not just shade.